AWS vs. Google Cloud: Service Models, Cost Structures, and Workload Suitability

AWS and Google Cloud Platform (GCP) take divergent approaches to cloud services. AWS is a low-level Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) cloud platform that offers more than 200 fine-grained primitives that allow for greater freedom in design but require additional effort in management (IJNRD, 2024; SpendArk, 2026). On the other hand, GCP focuses on abstraction and convenience, providing developers with a highly opinionated approach to architecture (GoCloud, 2026; SpendArk, 2026). It supports around 150 cloud services (GoCloud, 2026; SpendArk, 2026).

In terms of financial commitment, AWS has a pay-as-you-go approach, but big discounts demand active participation in Savings Plans and Reserved Instances (Slingerland, 2026; SpendArk, 2026). On the other hand, GCP has a more straightforward pricing structure with per-second billing, 200 GB of free monthly egress and auto-applied sustained use discounts of up to 30% that do not require upfront commitment (SpendArk, 2026; GoCloud, 2026).

As such, AWS is the preferred platform for mission-critical applications, traditional infrastructure, and regulatory requirements (IJNRD, 2024; SpendArk, 2026). Conversely, GCP provides AI-powered services, big data solutions, and container orchestration capabilities (GoCloud, 2026; SpendArk, 2026).

References:

- **GoCloud** (2026) GCP vs AWS 2026 | Which Cloud Platform Is Better?. GoCloud. Available at: https://go-cloud.io/gcp-vs-aws/

- **IJNRD** (2024) Evaluating Scalable Solutions: A Comparative Study of AWS, Azure, and GCP. International Journal of Novel Research and Development (IJNRD).
- **Slingerland, C.** (2026) AWS Vs. GCP: Which Platform Offers Better Pricing?. CloudZero. Available at: https://www.cloudzero.com/blog/aws-vs-gcp/
- **SpendArk** (2026) AWS vs Google Cloud: Pricing Comparison for Small Teams (2026). SpendArk. Available at: https://spendark.com/blog/aws-vs-gcp-pricing/